

User Observation Record — Participant 2

Participant: P2

Date: October 6, 2026

System: Amazon

Session Type: Contextual observation

Primary Task: Search for a product, filter results, review a product, and determine whether to purchase it.

Approximate Session Length: 13 minutes

Task 1 — Search for a Product

Task given to participant:

"Find a wireless keyboard that you would consider purchasing."

Observations

The participant searched for "wireless keyboard." After the results appeared, they immediately began examining product titles and star ratings.

The participant clicked on a sponsored result without initially realizing that it was sponsored.

After looking at the product page, they returned to the search results.

Participant quote:

"Oh, I didn't realize this was an ad."

Pain Point

The participant initially interpreted the sponsored product as a normal search result.

Potential heuristic: Visibility of System Status / Match Between the System and the Real World

Severity: 3 — Major usability problem

Task 2 — Use Search Filters

Task given to participant:

"Limit the results to products under \$50."

Observations

The participant scrolled down the left side of the page looking for the price filter.

They initially overlooked the filter because of the number of other filtering options.

After locating it, they selected a price range.

Participant quote:

"There are way too many filters."

The participant successfully applied the filter but then continued scrolling through the page to confirm that the results had changed.

Pain Point

The participant had difficulty locating the appropriate filter among numerous options.

Potential heuristic: Recognition Rather Than Recall / Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Severity: 2 — Minor usability problem

Task 3 — Determine Whether to Purchase

Task given to participant:

"Look at the product information and decide whether you would purchase this keyboard."

Observations

The participant looked at the product title, price, rating, and reviews. They then searched for shipping information.

They initially expected shipping information to be located near the price.

Participant quote:

"I was looking for when it would get here."

The participant eventually found the shipping information but had to scan multiple sections of the page.

Pain Point

The participant expected important purchasing information to be grouped together, but relevant information was distributed across different areas of the page.

Potential heuristic: Match Between the System and the Real World

Severity: 2 — Minor usability problem

Overall Participant Findings

The participant's main difficulties were:

1. Recognizing sponsored content.
2. Finding the appropriate search filter.
3. Locating shipping information.
4. Understanding how different pieces of product information were organized.

Overall Participant Impression

The participant successfully completed all three tasks but experienced several moments of hesitation. The most significant issue was difficulty distinguishing advertisements from ordinary search results. The participant also expected important purchasing information to be grouped together in a more predictable manner.